DAYS GONE

STORYLINE:

In Days Gone you assume the role of Deacon St. John, a former biker turned drifter who is searching for a reason to carry on after being separated from his wife and being uncertain of her fate in a world gone crazy. A global pandemic has razed the world; the infection transforming the vast majority of humanity into grotesque creatures called Freaks or Swarmers. Their sole purpose for existence is to feed on the living and the dead and an endless stream of them are drifting north into Oregon from the coastal population centers. Small bands of survivors have clustered together in fortified camps to resist the infected hordes and the roving bands of raiders that roam the lawless land, murdering and robbing. A particularly abhorrent cult of miscreants called Rippers have a vendetta against Deacon and his sidekick, Boozer. Threatening everyone and everything is a crusading Colonel commanding a well-armed militia and he means to pursue a campaign of genocide on the unworthy. The massive struggle for survival will unfold in the hostile and remote Oregon countryside.

WEAPONS:

In Days Gone you carry a knife, a melee weapon and you have three weapon slots-one for a Sidearm, one for a Primary Weapon and one for a Special Weapon. This will not change during the campaign but you can swap out any purchased or awarded weapon at any camp or Gun Locker in a NERO Checkpoint or Ambush Camp.You'll start the game with a 9MM handgun and, very early on, you'll receive a crossbow. You can also pick up and equip weapons dropped by enemies and you can purchase weapons with credits at Hot Springs Camp and later at the camps at the Lost Lake and Wizard Island.

Some weapons are awarded for completion of missions. **Boozer's Shotgun**, for example, is unlocked after completing the main mission, **I Could Use a Hand** during the gameplay at Lost Lake Camp; the **Rock Chuck assault rifle** is awarded for completion of the Marauder Camp Hunter storyline. Other weapons and items like remote bombs, pipe bombs, attractors, etc. and the recipes for weapons and gear can be earned through gameplay.

Explosives like grenades, pipe bombs and Molotovs also play a huge role in the game. Molotovs can be crafted very early in the game, pipe bombs much later while grenades can be purchased when your Trust Level allows. These items can also occasionally be found in the environment. Molotovs are necessary for burning out Infestations and they play an important role in the campaign.

Upgrading your arsenal is essential to survival. Following are the weapons I recommend and that are available during normal gameplay. Some weapons like, for example, the MG 55 heavy machine gun and the Talon 7 sniper rifle, aren't included-not because the Talon 7 isn't an excellent weapon-but because reaching a Trust Level of 3 at Lost Lake Camp before moving into the next region just isn't realistic and a better sniper rifle-the .50 BFG will be available during the normal progression of the campaign. The MG 55 heavy machine gun requires killing half of the hordes, so it can only be gotten by grinding, likely long after you have completed the main campaign. Shotguns are not a good alternative to larger magazine assault rifles and sub-machine guns that have good range and can be suppressed. I don't recommend any of the shotguns that are available during a normal campaign.

Melee Weapons: You always have a boot knife. It is deadly for takedowns but is weak for engaging an enemy outside of stealth. It is unbreakable, but regular melee weapons have both a Damage and

Durability meter and they will drop out of your inventory when depleted. These weapons are found in the environment and range from planks to baseball bats, fire axes and machetes. Some melee weapons can be crafted from items found in the environment after earning a Crafting Recipe to do so. The **Spiked Bat**, for example, can be crafted after earning the recipe for completion of the early-game main mission, **No Starving Patriots**. It has good damage, downing a normal enemy with four hits rather than the eight it normally takes to down an enemy with a baseball bat. It is also more durable than most found melee weapons. When you complete only 29% of the **Ambush Camp Hunter** storyline, you earn the Baseball Bat Axe Recipe. This weapon requires having the bat, scrap and a saw blade and it delivers high damage and has high durability. It is a viable melee weapon for the remainder of the campaign or until you fins a **Superior Metal Axe** in the Crater Lake region..

The Tier 1 skill, **Field Repairs** in the **Melee Tree**, enables the player to repair any melee weapon. **Hard-Hitter** in the same tree greatly enhances the damage of melee weapons. **Home Run** requires extensive investment in the Melee Tree but it significantly increased melee damage. These weapons will play a large role in the campaign-so keep yours in good repair or exchange it before you're holding only the knife.

Recommended Melee Weapons:

Spiked Baseball Bat-you will obtain the Craft Recipe for this weapon after completion of No Starving Patriots in S 2.

Baseball Bat Axe-you'll be awarded the Craft Recipe for this weapon after you complete 29% of the Ambush Camp Hunter storyline.

Superior Metal Axe-this is the game's best melee weapon and it can be found after entering the Crater Lake region. Several locations where this excellent weapon can be obtained will be detailed in the narrative. With **Home Run**, this weapon can down a Reacher or a Breaker with only 5 strokes and it will down normal enemies with one.

Suppressors: Suppressors in Days Gone are makeshift-being constructed from oil filters; and, as such, will deteriorate over time. A sidearm suppressor, for example, will degrade 4% with each shot. They can be affixed to most weapons and can be attached and removed as required. Approach the enemy with stealth, using a suppressed weapon until discovered, then remove it to keep it viable. Availability at Merchants varies, depending on your Trust Level, but they are cheap. A sidearm suppressor costs only 30 credits; a primary suppressor 45 credits and a special suppressor 60 credits. You will occasionally find one under the hood of a vehicle-don't miss the one available at Crazy Willies during the main mission, **You Got A Death Wish**, which is detailed in Section 2: He Can't Be Far. Finding it will make your early operations less grueling.

Ammunition: You can find much of your ammo in the environment. Your victims will have ammo, there will be random ammo boxes and nearly all police vehicles will have an ammo box in the trunk. Merchants also sell ammo and it is relatively cheap. It can also be purchased at Gun Lockers at NERO Checkpoints and at liberated Ambush Camps.

Explosives and Incendiaries: Molotovs and explosives like grenades, pipe bombs. proximity bombs and remote bombs will be unlocked when you achieve a certain percentage completion of storylines during the campaign. These items can also be found in the environment and grenades can be purchased when

your trust level unlocks them. These munitions can be extremely effective at certain points of the campaign. The items required for crafting explosives and Molotovs can be gleaned from the environment. Molotovs are critical for the torching of Infestations.

Sidearms:

9MM handgun: This will be your starting weapon. It will be a staple until you can upgrade to the SAP9. It will down regular humans and Freaks with a single headshot; and, when equipped with a suppressor, it will serve you well in the game's early action. Be aware that killing anything will require multiple body shots with this weapon.

SAP9 handgun: You can purchase this when you reach Trust Level 1 in Hot Springs Camp for 500 credits. Buy it. It is cheap, can be suppressed and is superior to the 9MM handgun.

Eliminator handgun: This weapon will be available when you reach Trust Level 2 in the Wizard Island Camp. It is well worth the 2,000 credits and it is a significant upgrade over the SAP9. It can also be equipped with a suppressor.

SMP9 machine pistol: This is the best sidearm in the game but it isn't easy to reach a Trust Level of 3 at Lost Lake Camp to obtain it before moving on to the next region, even if you do all of the available missions. However, killing 4 hordes will earn the weapon and it may be available late in the game during the transition back to the northern region. It can be suppressed, it's potent, has a large magazine size and is the game's finest sidearm.

Primary Weapons:

SAF assault rifle: In my opinion this is the best option of the early-game Primary Weapons. When equipped with a suppressor, it can silently dispose of regular enemies with a headshot and its range and rate of fire makes it useful when engaged in a firefight.

MWS assault rifle: When this weapon becomes available at Trust Level 2 in Hot Springs Camp, it is well worth the 2,000 credits. It is by far the best of the available Primary Weapons at that point in the game and will be viable until you can purchase the game-changing Chicago Typewriter.

Chicago Typewriter: This is a game-changer. It is powerful, accurate, fast-firing, has a large magazine and can be suppressed. It can also be obtained at a reachable Trust Level of 2 at Wizard Island Camp. This will serve you well for the balance of the game and makes eliminating hordes doable.

Rock Chuck assault rifle: This smooth operating assault rifle has a built-in suppressor and is awarded for completion of the **Marauder Camp Hunter** storyline. While not quite as potent as the Chicago Typewriter, its built-in suppressor makes it an excellent weapon. Its only limitation is that it has a magazine of 35 and you can carry 175 additional rounds while the Chicago Typewriter sub-machine gun has a magazine of 55 and you can carry an additional 275 rounds.

Special Weapons:

Crossbow: You will receive this weapon very early in the campaign and it will remain your best Special Weapon option until you receive the Drifter Crossbow. The utility of the crossbow will be greatly enhanced by selecting the ability **Nocked-Up**, which will greatly enhance its potency. This will make body shots fatal to most enemies rather than requiring headshots, which are more difficult and more likely to

spoil stealth when an enemy is wounded rather that dispatched. Fire bolts and explosive bolts will become available when you reach 57% and then 86% completion of the Ambush Camp Hunter storyline.

M40 sniper rifle: This is a decent situational weapon, which is hampered by its low ammo capacity, making the crossbow a more viable normal Special Weapon, but at several points in the campaign the scope makes it a better option. It can be purchased at Hot Springs Camp at Trust Level 2 and it can be suppressed. Even though it is a sniper rifle, headshots are generally required for one-shot kills. This weapon can frequently be confiscated from a deceased enemy sniper.

Drifter Crossbow: This weapon is awarded for completion of the main mission, **We've All Done Things,** making it available for much of the campaign. This is a significant upgrade over the original crossbow and with the **Nocked-Up** skill will be a viable Special Weapon until you can purchase the .50 BFG sniper rifle when you achieve a Trust Level of 2 at Wizard Island Camp.

MG45 machine gun: This requires reaching Trust Level 3 at Hot Springs Camp to purchase for 2,500 credits-this is a tall order, but one can frequently be confiscated from a downed gunner once you reach the Lost Lake region. It can be equipped with a suppressor and can provide massive firepower. It is a viable alternative to the Drifter Crossbow as a Special Weapon.

.50 BFG sniper rifle: This, in my opinion, is the best weapon in the game. It is powerful, has a large magazine and with the **Up The Ante** skill, you can carry 25 rounds. It can be suppressed and can easily kill from great range. It will cost 3,000 credits when you achieve a Trust Level of 2 at Wizard Island Camp, making it available for a good percentage of the game. If you favor stealth and sniping, it will remain your Special Weapon for the balance of the game.

RPD machine gun: This machine gun can be purchased at Wizard Island Camp once you reach a Trust Level of 2. It can be suppressed; and, if you're going after a horde, pairing it with the Chicago Typewriter will give you massive firepower and plenty of ammo to cut down a horde.

ABILITIES:

You will slowly amass skill points during game play, which can be invested in the three skill trees-**Ranged**, **Survival** and **Melee**. Investing the first skill point in **Focused Shot** is a no-brainer. This skill enables the player to briefly slow time in order to better focus a ranged shot. This will make lethal headshots with the weak early game weapons more doable. **Field Repairs** permits the player to repair a melee weapon with scrap gleaned from the environment, allowing him to keep a favorite weapon which would otherwise be lost.

Not all abilities are created equal but if you favor the crossbow, investing the next 4 ability points in the **Ranged Tree** to acquire **Nocked-Up** will make the crossbow much more potent. It will kill normal enemies with body shots rather than a much more difficult headshot. This makes the crossbow a much more effective stealth weapon and will make the Drifter Crossbow, obtained later in the game, much more potent. The Drifter Crossbow, for example, can kill an armored foe with only 2 bolts.

Investing heavily in the **Survival Tree** to acquire **Ear To The Ground** and **Carry That Weight** will greatly enhance both survivability and combat**. Ear To The Ground** will highlight enemies with Survival Vision. This is one of the games most useful abilities both for survival and for combat. Investing 2 additional skill points in the **Survival Tree** nets **Carry That Weight**, which greatly increases your carrying capacity,

enabling you to tote 6 Molotovs, 6 grenades, etc. and additional items to craft more. This is a must for operations late in the game. Investing in the Melee Tree to obtain **Hard Hitter** and **Home Run** will greatly increase the potency of your melee weapon. **Field Repairs** will enable the player to repair a melee weapon with scrap and it is one of the game's essential skills.